

GLOBAL FASHION AND DESIGN WEEK

AFT School of
Interior Design

Graduating Project 2026

SOUTH AFRICA — LOOKBOOK —

DESIGN • CULTURE • WILDLIFE



Designed by Nandini Khandelwal and Jawom Singpho

Acknowledgement

We would like to express our sincere gratitude to our guardians for their constant support, encouragement, and belief in us throughout our academic journey. Their guidance and motivation have been a strong foundation for completing this project.

We are deeply thankful to our mentor, Mr. Pranjal Singh Pawar, Assistant Professor, for his valuable guidance, patience, and continuous support. His insights and constructive feedback have helped us refine our ideas and successfully bring this project to life.

We would also like to extend my appreciation to all faculty members and everyone who contributed directly or indirectly to the successful completion of Sculpted Savannah.

Contents

<i>01</i>	Acknowledgement	<i>1</i>
<i>02</i>	About the Designers	<i>3</i>
<i>03</i>	Client profile	<i>4</i>
<i>04</i>	Country profile	<i>5-6</i>
<i>05</i>	Furniture research	<i>7</i>
<i>06</i>	Design concept	<i>8</i>
<i>07</i>	Mood Board	<i>9</i>
<i>08</i>	Drawings	<i>10</i>
<i>09</i>	Materials and Costing	<i>11</i>
<i>10</i>	Final Setup	<i>12</i>
<i>11</i>	Conclusion	<i>13</i>

About The Designers

We are postgraduate diploma students in interior design, united by our passion for transforming ideas into meaningful furniture pieces. Our project, Sculpted Savannah, is inspired by the raw beauty and natural rhythm of South Africa, where landscapes, textures, and culture come together in harmony.

Sculpted Savannah reflects our exploration of organic forms and earthy elements found in the African savanna. The flowing lines, bold structures, and natural materials in our design aim to capture the essence of wildlife, open landscapes, and traditional craftsmanship.

We believe furniture should go beyond function — it should tell a story. Through this project, we have focused on creating pieces that are not only practical but also expressive and culturally inspired. By blending modern design approaches with natural influences, we aim to create furniture that feels grounded, powerful, and timeless.

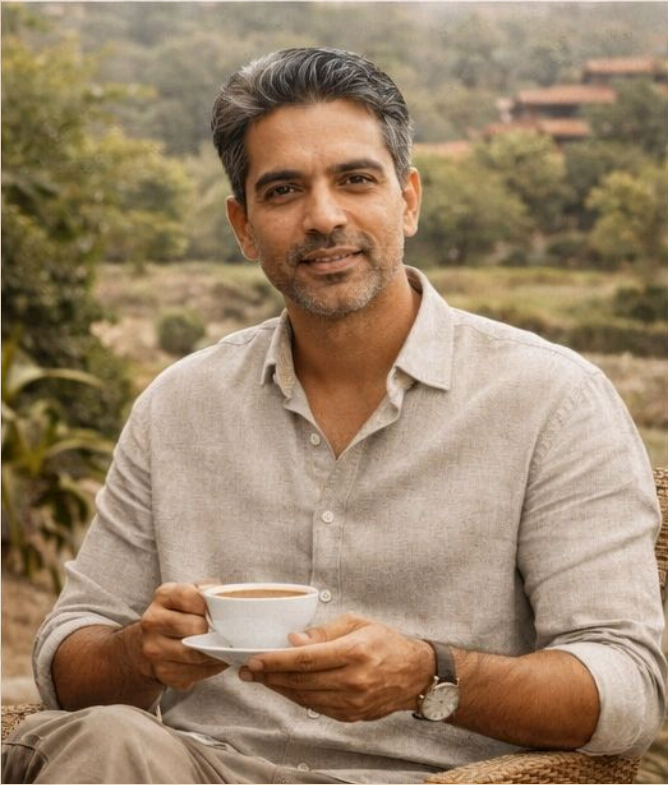
Our work represents creativity, experimentation, and attention to detail, while celebrating the connection between nature, culture, and design.

“Inspired by nature, shaped by design.”



THE CONSCIOUS LUXURY EXPLORER

Client Profile: Luxury Resort in Jim Corbett, Ramnagar



Arjun Mehra

Age: 42

Profesion: Founder of a boutique eco-hospitality group

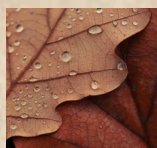
Location: New Delhi / Travels frequently.

Client Narrative

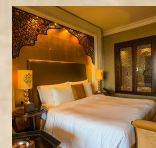
Arjun Mehta represents a new generation of Luxury hospitality clients-individuals who seek to merge refined aesthetics with sustainability. He prioritizes destinations that offer immersive nature experiences without compensating on comfort and elegance, making the design of each resort space a critical balance of luxury and respnsibility



Eco-Focused

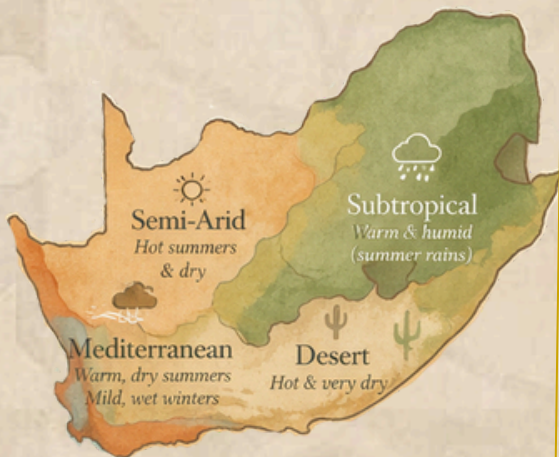


Nature-Oriented



Luxury Hospitality

Country Profile



Design Takeaway

Inspired by South Africa rich wiltural diversity, and handcrafted traditions, the design focuses on organic forms, storytelling through carving, natural materials.

Flag

The national flag of South Africa is colorful and symbolizes unity and diversity. It includes green, black, yellow, white, red, and blue, representing the country's rich cultural heritage and transition towards democracy.

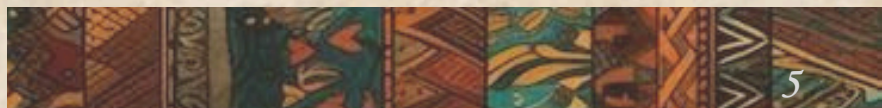
Geographical Conditions:

South Africa is located at the southern tip of Africa. It is surrounded by the Atlantic Ocean on the west and the Indian Ocean on the east. The country has diverse landscapes including mountains, plateaus, grasslands (savannah), and coastal regions.

Climatology:

South Africa has a generally mild and sunny climate. Summers are warm to hot, while winters are cool. Different regions experience different climates—Mediterranean in the southwest, subtropical in the east, and semi-arid in the interior.

A country where nature, culture, and craftsmanship exist in harmony.



Famous For:

South Africa is famous for:

- Wildlife safaris and national parks
- Rich cultural diversity
- Gold and diamond mining
- Beautiful landscapes like Table Mountain
- Traditional art and crafts



Local Materials Used in Design:

- Wood (especially hardwoods)
- Bamboo (in some regions)
- Stone and clay
- Natural fibers (grass, reeds)

These materials inspire sustainable and earthy furniture design.



Famous Food:

Your paragraph text

- Braai (barbecue)
- Biltong (dried meat)
- Bobotie (spiced minced dish)
- Bunny chow (bread filled with curry)



Unique Aspects:

- National Animal: Springbok (antelope)
- National Bird: Blue Crane
- Known as the “Rainbow Nation” due to its cultural diversity
- 11 official languages



Furniture Research

Sculpted Savannah



The chair is one of the most important and widely used pieces of furniture, serving both functional and aesthetic purposes. In ancient times, chairs were symbols of power and status, used mainly by royalty and elite classes. Over time, their use became more common, and the focus shifted towards comfort, usability, and design. Today, chairs are not only essential for seating but also play a key role in enhancing the visual appeal of a space.

Chairs are designed in different types based on their function, such as office chairs for work, study chairs for reading, dining chairs for meals, and lounge chairs for relaxation. Among these, the accent chair stands out as a statement piece that adds character and style to interiors while still being functional.



For our project, we have chosen to design an accent chair under the concept Sculpted Savana. This concept is inspired by the natural beauty and landscapes of South Africa. The design reflects organic forms, smooth curves, and bold structures inspired by the African Savannah.

Design Focus

The focus of our chair is on combining sculptural aesthetics with comfort and usability. By using earthy materials and nature-inspired forms, the design aims to create a strong visual impact while maintaining functionality. The chair is not just a seating element but a representation of culture, nature, and modern design thinking.



Design concept

The design concept of Sculpted Savannah is inspired by the natural beauty and cultural richness of South Africa.

The chair reflects the essence of the African savannah, known for its vast landscapes, flowing terrains, and strong connection to nature.

The form of the chair is influenced by organic shapes and smooth curves, representing the natural flow of land and wildlife movement. The sculptural structure gives the chair a bold and powerful presence, similar to the strength and stability seen in nature.



The choice of materials is inspired by locally available resources such as wood and natural fibers, which reflect sustainability and traditional craftsmanship. Earthy tones like browns, beige, and warm neutrals are used to represent the soil, grasslands, and natural environment of the savannah.



The design also connects with South African culture through its emphasis on handmade quality and artistic expression. It aims to blend traditional inspiration with modern design, creating a chair that is both functional and visually striking.

Overall, Sculpted Savannah is not just a piece of furniture but a representation of nature, culture, and design harmony, bringing the spirit of South Africa into a contemporary interior space.

Mood Board



Material:

MERANTI HARDWOOD

- Warm, rich tone
- Durable & hand-carved
- Natural quality wood



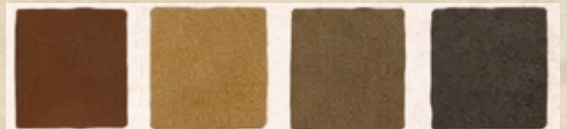
Inspiration & details

Cultural fusion

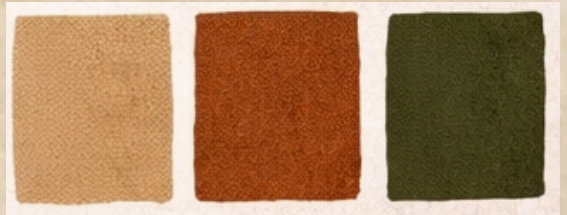
Sculptural

natural

Earthy luxury

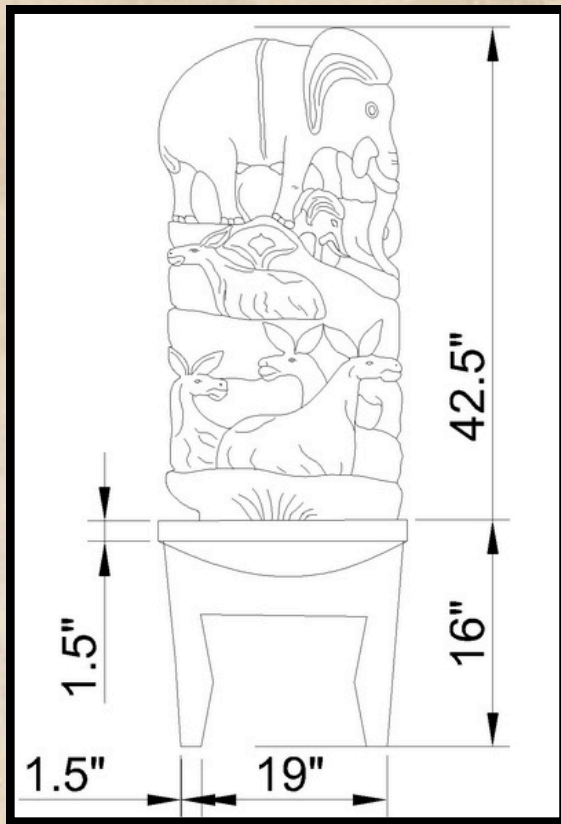


Earthy Color Palette

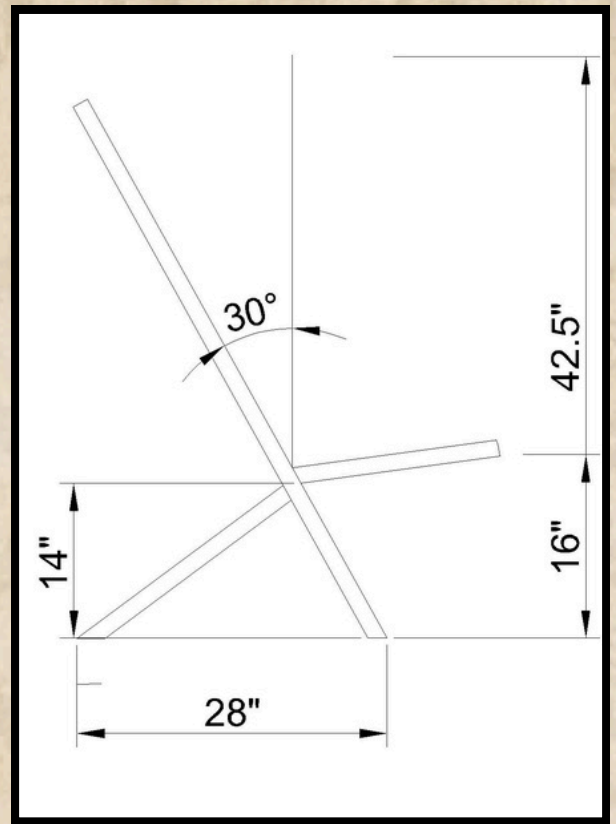


- Wood Carvings
- Handwoven natural fibers
- Cultural safari themes

Drawings



Front Elevation



Side Elevation



3D Visualisation

Materials and Costing

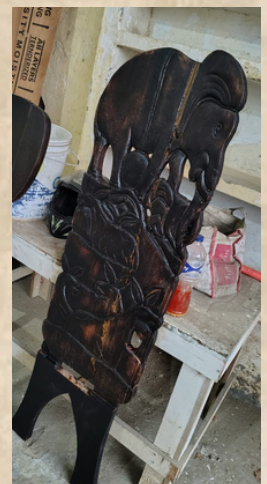
Material and Procedure

- Meranti or Philippine Mahogany wood - Procedure
- Process Included:
 - Cutting of wood pieces
 - Slot cutting (lock joint system)
 - Rebonding (adhesive joining)
 - CNC cutting for detailed design
 - Burning finish using flame torch
 - Final polishing and assembly



Costing

- Wood Slab - Rs. 2000/Slab
- CNC Cut and Wood burning - Rs. 3500
- Polish - Rs. 2000
- Labour cost - Rs. 2500
- Transportation - Rs. 1500
- Designer's cost - Rs. 3000
- Total Costing - Rs. 17000



Final Product



Conclusion

The journey of creating Sculpted Savannah has been more than just a design process—it has been a meaningful experience of connection, creativity, and growth. Every stage, from understanding the landscapes of South Africa to shaping the final form, has been a step toward bringing an idea to life.

This project allowed us to feel the essence of nature through design—the calmness of open savannah, the strength of natural forms, and the beauty of simplicity. Each curve, texture, and material choice reflects not only inspiration but also the effort, patience, and passion behind the work.

There were challenges, changes, and moments of rethinking, but each of them helped us grow as designers. Sculpted Savannah is not just a chair; it is a reflection of our journey, our learning, and our ability to turn imagination into reality.

In the end, this project stands as a reminder that design is not only about creating objects, but about expressing emotions, telling stories, and leaving a lasting impression.



"Crafted with purpose, grounded in nature."

